

Module 11: Migrant Lives and Identities

Service Learning Project

Belonging in Practice: Mentorship with Migrant Youth or Newcomer Programs

Overview

Serve as a mentor, tutor, or program assistant with a migrant youth or newcomer program, then analyze how the program supports — or overlooks — the identity dynamics studied in this module.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe identity dynamics observed in programming (UG 1)
- Identify forms of exclusion and how programs counter them (UG 2)
- Explain intersectionality using concrete program design questions (UG 3)
- Recognize diversity within migrant communities (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Newcomer youth mentoring and tutoring programs
- Community centers with intercultural programming
- School-based newcomer academies
- Girls'/women's groups, disability services, or LGBTQ+ newcomer programs (identity-specific settings)

Project steps

1. Complete partner training including youth-protection requirements (background check where required).
2. Serve consistently — the same program, 5+ sessions; relationships are the point.
3. Observe (journal, de-identified) how age, gender, language, disability, and legal status interact in participants' experiences.
4. Analyze the program itself through an intersectional lens: whom does its design fit best? Who might it unintentionally miss?
5. Discuss your analysis with program staff as a constructive conversation, not a critique dropped on them.
6. Final paper: identity-informed program reflection.

Deliverables

- Session log with site sign-off
- Observation journal (de-identified)
- 4-page intersectional program analysis

Time commitment

16–18 hours across at least five sessions.

Ethics requirements

Youth-protection rules are absolute; students never probe participants' status, trauma, or family situations.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Commitment and relationship quality, per site feedback 30%	Exceptional professionalism: commitment and relationship quality, per site feedback is confirmed by strong partner or site feedback; the student was consistently prepared, dependable, and left the partner concretely better off.	Solid professionalism: commitment and relationship quality, per site feedback is confirmed by positive partner feedback; commitments were met with only minor scheduling or preparation issues.	Inconsistent professionalism: commitment and relationship quality, per site feedback is partially met — missed sessions, uneven preparation, or partner feedback indicating the student required significant management.	Inadequate professionalism: commitment and relationship quality, per site feedback is not met; commitments were unmet or the partner's experience was negative.
Sound use of identity/intersectionality concepts 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: sound use of identity/intersectionality concepts goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: sound use of identity/intersectionality concepts is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: sound use of identity/intersectionality concepts is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: sound use of identity/intersectionality concepts is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Fairness and constructiveness of program analysis 25%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: fairness and constructiveness of program analysis goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: fairness and constructiveness of program analysis is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: fairness and constructiveness of program analysis is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: fairness and constructiveness of program analysis is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Journal reflection quality 15%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: journal reflection quality shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: journal reflection quality shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: journal reflection quality is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: journal reflection quality shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.